Since Mud Slap got nerfed this season in Pokémon GO, would Gastrodon be better running Mud Shot?

In short: **Yes, Mud Shot is making a strong case for Gastrodon again.** With the start of the **Memories in Motion** season (March 2026), the Ground-type fast move meta has completely flipped. While **Mud Slap** dominated the previous few seasons, the recent adjustments have made it slower, while **Mud Shot** received a significant energy generation buff.

Here is the breakdown of how the moves compare for Gastrodon right now:

The Move Rebalance (March 2026)

Move	Changes	Current Stats (Trainer Battles)
Mud Slap	**Nerfed:** Power decreased from 12 → 11.	Moderate damage, moderate energy.
Mud Shot	**Buffed:** Energy generation increased; Power decreased from 4 → 3.	Low damage, **High energy generation.**

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Which one should you choose?

1. The Case for Mud Shot (The "Spammy" Choice)

Since Gastrodon relies heavily on its Charged Attacks (**Body Slam** for baiting/neutral damage and **Earth Power** or **Water Pulse** for nuking), the buff to Mud Shot's energy generation is huge.

- **Faster Pacing:** You will reach Body Slams much quicker, allowing you to outpace opponents and force shields.
- **The "Mud Boy" Classic:** It returns Gastrodon to the traditional playstyle of Whiscash or Quagsire—sacrificing fast move damage to overwhelm the opponent with Charged Attack pressure.

2. The Case for Mud Slap (The "Farm Down" Choice)

Even with the nerf from 12 to 11 power, Mud Slap still hits significantly harder than Mud Shot.

- **Winning the Lead:** If you are using Gastrodon to counter Steel, Poison, or Rock types (like Bastiodon or Clodsire), Mud Slap can sometimes "farm them down" without you needing to spend energy.
- **Consistency:** It provides more reliable damage if the opponent is skilled at catching your Charged Moves on a different Pokémon.

The Verdict

Switch to Mud Shot if you find yourself losing matches because you're "just one turn away" from a move. In the current 2026 meta, where energy generation is king, Mud Shot's ability to spam **Body Slam** makes Gastrodon a much more volatile and dangerous threat.

However, if your team specifically needs Gastrodon to melt Steels with fast move pressure alone, **Mud Slap** is still viable, just less "oppressive" than it was last season.

Would you like me to look up a specific team core to see which move fits your current Great League lineup better?

Does Mud Shot actually work better for energy generation on Gastrodon?

Yes, **Mud Shot is mathematically better for energy generation** than Mud Slap on Gastrodon following the March 2026 "Memories in Motion" update.

The core reason is that the energy-to-turn ratio has shifted heavily in Mud Shot's favor. While Mud Slap was the undisputed king for the last two seasons, the current stats make a switch to Mud Shot much more rewarding for "spammy" playstyles.

Fast Move Comparison (March 2026 Stats)

Stat	**Mud Shot** (New)	**Mud Slap** (Nerfed)
Energy Per Turn (EPT)	**4.5**	3.33
Damage Per Turn (DPT)	1.5	**3.66**
Turn Duration	2 Turns (1.0s)	3 Turns (1.5s)

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How this affects Gastrodon's moves

Gastrodon typically runs **Body Slam** (35 Energy) as its primary bait or spam move. Here is how many turns it takes to reach it with each move:

- **With Mud Shot:** You generate **9 energy** every 2 turns.
  - It takes **4 Mud Shots (8 turns)** to reach your first Body Slam.
- **With Mud Slap:** You generate **10 energy** every 3 turns.
  - It takes **4 Mud Slaps (12 turns)** to reach your first Body Slam.

> [!IMPORTANT]
> **The Difference:** Using Mud Shot allows you to reach your first Charged Attack **2 full seconds (4 turns) faster** than Mud Slap. In a fast-paced Great League match, that is often the difference between winning a lead and being forced to use a shield.

Is there any reason to keep Mud Slap?

While Mud Shot is better for energy, Mud Slap still deals **244% more damage** per turn.

- **Keep Mud Slap** if your team uses Gastrodon as a "closer" to clean up weakened Steel or Poison types where you don't want to rely on shields.
- **Switch to Mud Shot** for almost all other scenarios. The ability to spam **Body Slam** and reach **Earth Power** or **Water Pulse** more quickly makes Gastrodon much more versatile against the current meta (especially against the recently buffed Galarian Stunfisk and Feraligatr).

Would you like me to check how these move changes affect your specific matchups against other "Mud Boys" like Quagsire or Whiscash?

When was Mud Shot added to Gastrodon?

Actually, Gastrodon doesn't technically "learn" Mud Shot!

While it feels like it should have it—especially since it's a "Mud Boy" like Whiscash and Quagsire—**Mud Shot has never been part of Gastrodon's movepool in Pokémon GO.**

It's a common point of confusion because:

1. **Whiscash, Quagsire, and Swampert** (the other Water/Ground types) all rely on Mud Shot.
2. Gastrodon is often compared to them in PvP discussions.
3. Gastrodon *does* learn Mud Shot in the main series games (like *Scarlet & Violet* or *Legends: Arceus*), but Niantic hasn't given it the move in GO yet.

Gastrodon's Actual Fast Moves

Gastrodon's Actual Fast Moves

As of the **Memories in Motion** season (March 2026), Gastrodon is limited to:

- **Mud Slap:** (The Ground-type choice)
- **Hidden Power:** (Generally unreliable due to random typing)
- **Water Gun:** (The Water-type choice, usually inferior to Mud Slap for coverage)

The "Mud Shot" Confusion

The reason people are talking about Mud Shot right now is that the move received a massive **energy generation buff** this season, making Pokémon like **Quagsire** and **Whiscash** incredibly spammy. Because Gastrodon's preferred move, **Mud Slap**, just got nerfed, many players *wish* it had Mud Shot to keep up.

Since Gastrodon is stuck with Mud Slap, it has shifted from being a "top meta threat" back to more of a "niche specialist" that beats Steel types but struggles to race other Mud Boys to their charged moves.

Would you like me to recommend a different Ground-type that actually uses the newly buffed Mud Shot for your team?

Sources

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Tools

Fast

Gemini is AI and can make mistakes.